9.12 Gout*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My big toe is red, hot and very painful." **Objective** • Swollen first metatarsophalangeal joint • Raised uric acid	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to urate crystal-induced inflammation as evidenced by severe joint pain and swelling.	• Pain relieved within 24–48 hours.	• Rest and elevate the joint. • Give an anti-inflammatory drug or colchicine as prescribed. • Use a bed cradle to keep sheets off the joint.	• Met when pain is relieved.
Subjective • "I eat a lot of red meat." **Objective** • Repeated attacks • High-purine diet	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge related to prevention of acute attacks as evidenced by a high-purine diet.	• Explains how to prevent attacks.	• Advise less red meat, offal and sugary drinks. • Encourage fluids. • Explain that urate-lowering treatment is long term.	• Achieved once the measures are explained back.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Uric acid stays high • Stops treatment once the pain settles	**RISK** Risk for physical injury as evidenced by risk factors: recurrent urate deposition and joint damage from interrupted urate-lowering therapy.	• Keeps taking urate-lowering therapy as prescribed.	• Explain why treatment is long term. • Arrange follow-up uric acid checks. • Advise against stopping the drug during an attack.	• Outcome reached if therapy continues as prescribed.

*References for this care plan: [21], [32], [35]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.